Montagu Chelmsford reforms 1919 introduced dyarchy in the presidencies by which a few departments were earmarked for Indian ministers chosen from the elected members. In the first elections under dyarchy in 1920, the Indian National Congress as a part of the Non-Co-operation Movement boycotted the elections, but many congressmen contested the elections under different banners. The Justice Party won majority of the seats and A.Subbarayalu became the First Minister and after his death, Raja of Panagal became the First Minister of Madras in 1921.



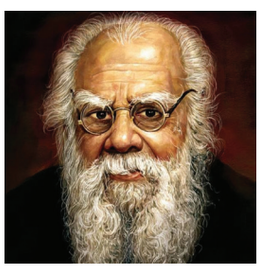


14.4 Contributions of Justice Party

In spite of the fluctuating fortunes in the subsequent elections, the Justice party continued to hold power from 1921 to 1937. They introduced a number of reforms. Through communal Government Order they ensured adequate number of opportunities to every category of non-brahmin communities. They removed discrimination against Sudras and Panchamas in public roads, transports, restaurants and public wells. They regulated the temple affairs through the newly constituted Hindu Religious Endowment Board, earmarked plots of land for the Panchamas (Panchami Land) introduced new township and industrial estates. Special efforts were taken to provide education for the children of depressed classess. For the first time they experimented with "Noon Meal Scheme" in a few schools. Knowledge of Sanskrit as the basic eligibility for medical education was removed which facilitated non-brahmin students gaining entry into medical education. On an initiative from Dr. Muthulakshmi and others, Devadasi system was abolished in Tami nadu and women were enfranchised. Co-operative societies were promoted. Mirasdari system was abolished, and a number of irrigation schemes were introduced in 1923. Annamalai University and Andhra University were founded during their regime. It was the Justic Party which provided the most successful government under the Dyarchy though they were assigned only a few departments.



14.5 Periyar E.V. Ramasamy:



Peiyar E.V. Ramasamy considered the decision of Rajaji's government to impose Hindi as a compulsory subject as a move to establish 'North Indian imperialism' and destroying the Tamil language and culture. Periyar, further, maintained that the imposition of Hindi was a calculated effort to sub ordinate the Dravidians in order to ascertain the supremacy of the Aryan Brahmins.

Madras Presidency has witnessed massive anti-Hindi agitations and

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